

AP S/4HANA SECURITY

Chapter 1 – S/4HANA Security Architecture & Transformation Strategy

Q111. What are the major security differences between ECC and S/4HANA?

Interviewer's Objective

This is probably the most common S/4HANA interview question.

The interviewer wants to know whether you understand that S/4HANA is not simply ECC running on HANA.

Executive Answer

Although S/4HANA retains the SAP authorization concept based on roles and authorization objects, the security architecture has evolved significantly.

Key differences include:

ECC	S/4HANA
SAP GUI-centric	SAP Fiori-first experience
Transaction-based access	App-based access
Limited analytics	Embedded Analytics
Customer/Vendor Master	Business Partner (BP)
Classic UI	SAP Fiori Launchpad
Limited OData usage	Extensive OData services
Separate frontend	Integrated user experience

Biggest Change

In ECC

Security focused primarily on

- **Transaction Codes**
- **Authorization Objects**

- **GUI**

In S/4HANA

Security must also protect

- **Fiori Apps**
 - **OData Services**
 - **CDS Views**
 - **Launchpad**
 - **Business Partner**
 - **Embedded Analytics**
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Q112. Explain Greenfield, Brownfield and Selective Data Transition.

A favorite S/4HANA interview question.

Greenfield

Completely new implementation.

Advantages

- **Fresh RBAC Design**
- **Clean Security Model**
- **Modern Fiori Roles**
- **No legacy authorization issues**

Security Focus

- **Business Personas**
 - **New Role Design**
 - **Fiori Security**
 - **SoD Design**
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Brownfield

System Conversion.

Existing ECC converted.

Advantages

- **Faster implementation**

Challenges

- **Legacy roles**
- **Obsolete transactions**
- **Historical SoD issues**

Security Focus

- **Role cleanup**
 - **Transaction replacement**
 - **SU24 review**
 - **Rule Set update**
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Selective Data Transition

Hybrid approach.

Only selected business processes or data are migrated.

Security Focus

- **Mixed role landscape**
 - **Data segregation**
 - **Access consistency**
 - **Dual-system governance**
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Interview Tip

Always explain the security implications, not just the implementation type.

Q113. What is the Security Team's role in an S/4HANA implementation?

Executive Answer

Security should be involved throughout the project lifecycle.

Discover

- **Security strategy**
 - **Governance framework**
 - **Initial SoD model**
 - **Security scope**
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Explore

- **Business workshops**
 - **Persona identification**
 - **RBAC design**
 - **Access requirements**
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Realize

- **Role build**
 - **Fiori catalogs**
 - **OData authorization**
 - **Security testing**
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Deploy

- **User provisioning**
 - **Cutover**
 - **Emergency access**
 - **Production readiness**
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Run

- **Hypercare**
- **Audit support**

- SoD monitoring
 - Continuous improvement
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Interview Tip

Never say Security starts during role creation.

Security starts during project planning.

Q114. What is the Security Scope of an S/4HANA Project?

This question was also referenced in your uploaded preparation material, but here it is expanded to an architect level.

Executive Answer

The security scope should include:

Business Security

- RBAC
 - Business Roles
 - Organizational Roles
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Technical Security

- SAP Authorization
 - RFC Security
 - Background Users
 - Interface Users
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Fiori Security

- Catalogs
- Spaces
- Pages

- **Launchpad**
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Governance

- **SAP GRC**
 - **SoD**
 - **Firefighter**
 - **ARM**
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Identity

- **IAS**
 - **IPS**
 - **SAP IDM**
 - **Microsoft Entra ID**
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Cloud

- **SAP BTP**
 - **Datasphere**
 - **SAC**
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Audit

- **ITGC**
 - **SOX**
 - **Internal Controls**
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Architect Insight

Many projects fail because Security is treated as role building.

In reality,

Role Building

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20%

Security Governance

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80%

Q115. Explain Business Partner Security.

Executive Answer

S/4HANA replaces the traditional Customer and Vendor master with the Business Partner (BP) concept.

Security must therefore control:

- **BP Creation**
- **BP Maintenance**
- **BP Display**
- **BP Relationships**
- **BP Roles**

This introduces new authorization considerations compared to ECC.

Interview Tip

When discussing S/4HANA Security, always mention Business Partner because interviewers expect candidates to understand this major simplification.

Q116. How do you approach Security during an S/4HANA Migration?

Executive Answer

I follow a structured methodology.

Step 1

Inventory existing roles.

Step 2

Remove obsolete transactions.

Step 3

Review SU24 proposals.

Step 4

Conduct business workshops.

Step 5

Identify business personas.

Step 6

Design enterprise RBAC.

Step 7

Design Fiori security.

Step 8

Run SAP GRC ARA.

Step 9

Perform SIT/UAT.

Step 10

Support cutover and hypercare.

Key Principle

Never perform a "lift and shift" of ECC roles into S/4HANA.

Use the transformation as an opportunity to redesign and simplify the security model.

Q117. Explain Security Testing in an S/4HANA Project.

Executive Answer

Security testing should occur throughout the implementation lifecycle.

Unit Testing

Validate individual roles and authorizations.

System Integration Testing (SIT)

Verify end-to-end business processes across modules.

User Acceptance Testing (UAT)

Confirm that business users can complete their daily activities with the assigned roles.

Regression Testing

Ensure new changes do not break existing access.

Security Validation

Confirm:

- **Authorization objects**
- **Fiori access**
- **OData services**
- **Organizational values**
- **SoD compliance**

Q118. What are the biggest security challenges in S/4HANA?

Executive Answer

Common challenges include:

- **Legacy role migration**
- **Fiori adoption**
- **Business Partner authorization**
- **OData security**
- **CDS authorization**
- **Embedded analytics**
- **Rule set updates**
- **Custom application security**
- **Tight project timelines**
- **User adoption**

Q119. How do you support Security during Cutover?

Executive Answer

During cutover I focus on:

- **User provisioning**
- **Production role validation**
- **Firefighter readiness**
- **Business critical users**
- **Interface users**
- **Batch users**
- **Role transport validation**
- **Emergency support plan**

Security must be fully prepared before business transactions begin.

Q120. Real Interview Scenario

Interviewer

"The business asks you to migrate all ECC roles directly into S/4HANA to save time. What would you recommend?"

Executive Answer

I would advise against a direct migration without analysis.

Although it may reduce short-term effort, it also carries forward legacy authorization issues, obsolete transactions, and existing SoD conflicts.

Instead, I would recommend:

- 1. Inventory and analyze current roles.**
- 2. Remove obsolete transactions.**
- 3. Validate business processes for the future-state S/4HANA environment.**
- 4. Define business personas and an enterprise RBAC model.**
- 5. Redesign roles to support Fiori applications, Business Partner, and embedded analytics.**
- 6. Validate with SAP GRC ARA.**
- 7. Test thoroughly before production.**

This approach requires more effort initially but produces a cleaner, more maintainable, and audit-ready security model that supports long-term business objectives.

Architect's Insight

One of the strongest messages you can give in an interview is:

"An S/4HANA migration is not a technical upgrade; it is a business transformation. Security should therefore be redesigned to align with future-state business processes rather than simply copied from ECC."

That statement reflects the mindset expected from a senior consultant or architect leading transformation programs.

Chapter Summary

You should now be comfortable discussing:

- **ECC vs. S/4HANA security**
 - **Greenfield, Brownfield, and Selective Data Transition**
 - **Security workstream responsibilities**
 - **Business Partner security**
 - **Migration strategy**
 - **Security testing**
 - **Cutover and hypercare**
 - **Transformation challenges**
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Next Chapter – SAP Fiori Security (Deep Dive)

**This is one of the most frequently tested areas in modern SAP Security interviews.
We'll cover:**

- **Fiori Security Architecture**
- **Frontend vs. Backend Roles**
- **Catalogs**
- **Groups**
- **Spaces**
- **Pages**
- **Target Mappings**
- **OData Services**
- **ICF Nodes**
- **Launchpad**
- **App Index**
- **Fiori Troubleshooting**

- **Real production scenarios**

This chapter is essential because almost every S/4HANA implementation today is Fiori-first, and interviewers expect senior consultants to explain the complete security model rather than just the terminology.